Shizhe Yu

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Education

Ph.D. in Economics, University of Wisconsin–Madison 2023–present
M.S. in Economics, University of Wisconsin–Madison (en route to Ph.D.) 2026
B.A. in Financial Economics, Peking University, *summa cum laude* 2019–2023

Research Fields

Industrial Organization

Working Papers

The No Surprises Act's Surprises: Arbitration, Network Exit, and Insurer Pricing
with Panle Jia Barwick, Anran Li, and Tianli Xia. NBER Working Paper No. 35717, 2026. [PDF]

Entry Deterrence and Quality Improvement: The Welfare Effects of Pharmaceutical Patent Evergreening
Working paper, draft available upon request.

Abstract: This paper studies the welfare effects of patent evergreening, the increasingly prevalent practice of layering secondary patents around a brand drug to extend effective market exclusivity. Using the universe of small-molecule drugs approved from 1995 to 2019, I find that secondary patenting delays generic entry, in a pattern suggestive of strategic incentives, and is negatively associated with investment in primary R&D. A back-of-the-envelope welfare analysis built on a structural demand model suggests that for the patent types that block entry, the loss from deterred generic competition decisively outweighs the gain from the associated quality improvements, and amounts to an average of $55–$140 per potential consumer.

The Asymmetric Effects of Symmetric Trade Policy: Airbus and Boeing
Working paper, draft available upon request.

Abstract: This paper analyzes the welfare effects of trade policy in the global commercial aircraft duopoly, focusing on the decades-long dispute between the European Union and the United States over Airbus and Boeing. We develop a structural model of demand and supply with endogenous product entry and use it to simulate the two principal policy instruments: subsidies and tariffs. The simulations show that nominally symmetric policies can generate markedly asymmetric firm-level outcomes because their effects depend on firms' underlying costs, product portfolios, and market positions. Endogenous product entry is the primary adjustment margin and accounts for most of the resulting profit and welfare effects.

Algorithmic Personalization and Digital Addiction: A Field Experiment on Douyin (TikTok)
with Qianyun (Carole) Gao, Yu Gao, and Juanjuan Meng. SSRN Working Paper No. 4885043.

Research Experience

Research Assistant to Jean-François Houde — Spring 2026
Research Assistant to Panle Jia Barwick — Summer 2025–present

Teaching Experience

University of Wisconsin–Madison
Statistics: Measurement in Economics (Econ 310) — Fall 2024, Spring 2025
Introduction to Economics (Econ 101) — Fall 2023, Spring 2024

Presentations

IIOC Annual Conference; EARIE Annual Conference — 2026

Honors and Awards

JPGI Summer Research Fellowship, University of Wisconsin–Madison — 2026

Skills

Programming: Python, Stata, Julia, Linux
Languages: Chinese Mandarin (native), English (fluent), Japanese (intermediate)

Last updated: October 27, 2026